

SECOND CONDITIONAL

TYPE 2



Type 2

- The **Second Conditional** is used to talk about:
 - *unreal situations in the present*
 - *imaginary situations in the future*
 - *unlikely possibilities*
 - *giving advice (especially with If I were you...)*
- The situation is **not true now** or **not likely to happen**.



BASIC FORM

- **If + Past Simple, S + would + V1 = S + would + V1 + if + Past Simple**
- If I had a million dollars, I would buy a mansion.
- If she knew the answer, she would tell us.
- If we lived near the sea, we would go swimming every day.



IMPORTANT IDEA

- The **past tense** does **NOT** mean **past time** here.
- It shows **unreality**.
 - If I had a car, I would drive to work.
- Meaning:
 - ✗ I don't have a car now.
 - ✓ This is an imaginary present situation.



PRESENT UNREAL SITUATIONS

- **If I had a map, I would lend it to you.**
 - Reality: I don't have a map.
- **If I lived near my office, I would be on time every day.**
 - Reality: I don't live near my office.
- **If I knew French, I would apply for that job.**
 - Reality: I don't know French.



FUTURE UNLIKELY SITUATIONS

- **If someone tried to blackmail me, I would tell the police.**
 - Reality: I don't expect anyone to blackmail me.
- **If a burglar came into my room, I would scream.**
 - Reality: I don't expect a burglar to come.
- **If I dyed my hair blue, everyone would laugh.**
 - Reality: I don't intend to dye my hair blue.



IF I WERE YOU

- **Structure:** If I were you, I would + verb - Used for advice.
- If I were you, I would study harder.
- If I were you, I would accept the offer.
- If I were you, I would wait a little longer.
- If I were you, I would buy that car.



WERE vs WAS

- In formal English, **were** is preferred for all subjects.
 - If I **were** rich, I would travel the world.
 - If she **were** here, she would help us.
 - If he **were** my teacher, I would learn a lot.
- Although **was** is possible in informal speech: - **If I was rich...**
- IELTS and academic English prefer: - **If I were rich...**



SPECIAL FORM

- *Used for very unlikely or hypothetical situations.*
- **Structure: If + Subject + were to + Verb, would + Verb**
 - If he **were to resign**, the company would suffer.
 - If Peter **were to apply**, he would get the job.
 - If Bahodir **were to lose** his job, it would be a disaster.
- **Comparison**
 - If he **resigned**, we would be surprised.
 - If he **were to resign**, we would be surprised.
- *The second sentence sounds more formal and less likely.*



MODAL VERBS IN THE MAIN CLAUSE

- Instead of **would**, we can use: **might** and **could**
- **WOULD** - (certain result)
 - If you tried again, you would succeed.
- **MIGHT** - (possible result)
 - If you tried again, you might succeed.
- **COULD** - (ability/possibility)
 - If I knew her number, I could call her.
 - If he had a permit, he could get a job.



IF + PAST CONTINUOUS

- *Used for unreal situations that are in progress.*
- **Structure: If + Past Continuous, would/could/might + Verb**
 - If we were going by boat, I would feel happier.
 - If my car were working, I could drive you home.
 - If Hasan were studying English, he could speak with foreigners.
- **Reality**
 - We aren't going by boat.
 - My car isn't working.
 - Hasan isn't studying English.



would/could/might + be + Ving

- If + Past Simple, S + would/could/might + be + Ving
- Simple Result
 - If I had a car, I **would drive** to work.
 - (One simple action.)
- Continuous Result
 - If I had a car, I **would be driving** to work now.
 - (An action in progress right now.)



Imaginary Present Situation

- Ongoing Present Result

- If I lived in Seoul, I would be studying Korean now.

 - **Reality:** I don't live in Seoul.

- If I had more free time, I would be reading a book now.

 - **Reality:** I don't have more free time.

- If she worked here, she would be sitting in this office now.

 - **Reality:** She doesn't work here.



Imaginary Present Situation

- **Future Ongoing Result**

- If I had enough money, I would be travelling around Europe next summer.
 - **Reality:** I don't have enough money.
- If he spoke English fluently, he would be studying abroad next year.
 - **Reality:** He doesn't speak English fluently.



Would vs Could vs Might

- **Would be + Ving** - Expected imaginary result.
 - If I lived near the university, I would be attending classes every day.
- **Could be + Ving** - Ability or possibility.
 - If I had a laptop, I could be working from home now.
- **Might be + Ving** - Uncertain possibility.
 - If she knew about the meeting, she might be preparing for it now.



Compare These Carefully

- **Second Conditional (Simple)**

- If I had a car, I would drive to work.
- Focus: the action itself.

- **Second Conditional (Continuous)**

- If I had a car, I would be driving to work now.
- Focus: the action in progress at this moment.



More Examples

■ Present Time

- If I were taller, I would be playing basketball professionally.
- If he had a visa, he would be studying in Korea now.
- If we lived near the beach, we would be swimming right now.

■ Future Time

- If I had enough money, I would be travelling the world next year.
- If she got the scholarship, she would be studying in Japan next semester.
- If they bought a bigger house, they would be living more comfortably.



SUMMARY

Structure	Meaning
If + Past, would + V	imaginary result (simple)
If + Past, would be + V-ing	imaginary result in progress
If + Past, could be + V-ing	possible ongoing result
If + Past, might be + V-ing	uncertain ongoing result



WERE INVERSION

- **Structure:** **If + were + subject... → Were + subject + ...**
- If I were you, I would apologize.
→ **Were I you**, I would apologize.
- If she were here, she would help us.
→ **Were she here**, she would help us.
- If Bilolhuja were my teacher, I would study harder.
→ **Were Bilolhuja my teacher**, I would study harder.
- If they were ready, we could leave.
→ **Were they ready**, we could leave.



WERE TO INVERSION

- **Structure:** If + S + were + to V1... → Were + S + to + V1...
- If Quddus were to apply, he would get the job.
→ **Were Quddus to apply**, he would get the job.
- If Bahodir were to lose his job, it would be a disaster.
→ **Were Bahodir to lose** his job, it would be a disaster.
- If the company were to close, many people would lose their jobs.
→ **Were the company to close**, many people would lose their jobs.



WERE TO INVERSION NEGATIVE

- **If + subject + were (negative) → Were + subject + not + adjective/verb**
 - If I weren't busy, I would help you.
→ Were I not busy, I would help you.
 - If he weren't so tired, he would come with us.
→ Were he not so tired, he would come with us.
 - If they weren't at home, we would visit them. →
 - If the teacher weren't here now, we would be sleeping. →



Special Fixed Expression

- *If it were not for... Means **Without...** – bo'lmasaydi*

- **Normal**

- If it were not for your help, I would fail.

- **Inverted**

- **Were it not for your help, I would fail.**

- Were it not for the rain, we would go out.

- Were it not for her support, I would quit.

- Were it not for technology, communication would be much slower.



PAST SIMPLE ✗ CANNOT BE INVERTED

- **Normal** - If I had more money, I would buy a house.
- ✗ Not: Had I more money...
- ✗ Not: Did I have more money...
- **Correct Way** - **If + S + V2/ed... → Were + S + to + V1...**
- If I had more money, I would buy a house. →
- **Were I to have** more money, I would buy a house. (very formal)
- If Aziza studied in this group, I could see her everyday. →



IMPORTANT IDEA

Normal Form

Inversion

If I were rich, I would travel.

Were I rich, I would travel.

If she were here, she would help.

Were she here, she would help.

If he were to resign, we'd suffer.

Were he to resign, we'd suffer.

If it were not for you, I'd fail.

Were it not for you, I'd fail.

